



ADU Planning Checklist

A homeowner checklist for feasibility, access, utilities, design and permit preparation.

HOMEOWNER RESOURCE

Use this resource to organize decisions and prepare for productive conversations with your contractor, designer and local building department.

Property Feasibility

- Confirm property jurisdiction and zoning information
- Identify property lines, easements and utility locations
- Review access for construction and future occupants
- Evaluate grading, drainage and fire access
- Confirm parking and address requirements with the jurisdiction

Program Decisions

Detached, attached or conversion	
Approximate square footage	
Bedrooms / bathrooms	
Intended use	
Accessibility goals	
Target budget range	

Utility Planning

- Electrical service capacity
- Water service and meter considerations
- Sewer connection route and elevation
- Gas or all-electric approach
- Heating, cooling and ventilation
- Solar or energy requirements to verify

Before Pricing Construction

- Obtain a measured site plan or survey when needed
- Develop a defined floor plan and exterior concept
- Identify finish level and appliance package
- Clarify permit, utility and impact fees
- Request proposals based on the same drawing set and assumptions

Project Notes

Educational resource only. Costs, schedules, permit requirements and construction methods vary by property, scope and jurisdiction. Confirm project-specific requirements with qualified professionals and the applicable authority.